

Trophy

Neumann Wins His First TEG Trophy

He led from round one, survived a quintuple bogey at the 8th, and still carded the round's second-best score.

Stuart Neumann has won the TEG 17 Trophy at Estoril Golf Club. It is his first. He led throughout the final round and crossed the line with his overall advantage extended from 12 to 13. Gregg Williams took the round and the Green Jacket lead with it. The Trophy was Neumann's alone, and is now his to defend.

It was not comfortable. Between the 7th and the 9th he bled nine shots. The low point was a quintuple-bogey 9 at the 8th, the hardest hole on the course. It was flanked by two double bogeys, which is at least a tidy way to arrange a disaster. In almost any other round, that stretch takes the title off him.

It didn't, because the accounting had been done earlier. Holes 4 to 6 yielded nine Stableford points, bogey-par-bogey. Three unremarkable holes, banked without ceremony. They paid for the 8th in full.

The round was also a personal landmark. His 92 was his best score at Estoril this TEG, a full 14 strokes better than the 106 he posted on his previous visit. That was the platform from which the Trophy was won. A champion's platform, assembled out of a number he would rather not have read aloud anywhere else.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Stuart Neumann
Green Jacket Gregg Williams
Wooden Spoon Alex Baker

ROUND STABLEFORD
DM 45 | SN 43 | GW 42 | AB 33 | JB 32

ROUND GROSS
DM +11 | GW +11 | SN +23 | JB +24 | AB +38

AFTER R4 • TROPHY
SN 156 | GW 143 | DM 142 | JB 131 | AB 127

AFTER R4 • GREEN JACKET
GW +66 | DM +82 | JB +93 | SN +105 | AB +148

David Mullin

Mullin Breaks the Estoril Record

The card of the week arrived a round too late to trouble either trophy race.

David Mullin set a new course record at Estoril Golf Club in the 2023 TEG, a gross 80 in round 4. The previous mark of 86 had stood across the group's six prior visits. It was only Mullin's second time at the course. He beat his own best there, a 94, by 14 shots.

It began like nothing of the kind. Bogeys at the 4th and the 5th, then a double bogey at the par-5 6th, one of the harder holes on the course. A birdie at the 7th stopped the slide. After that the round simply gathered. Nine Stableford points across

holes 11 to 13. Not a gross shot dropped at 12-13, at 16-17, or at 2-3, the last of those including a birdie.

Set beside round 3 it barely looks like the same man: 30 Stableford points then, 45 now, a swing of 15. Mullin will be keen that the record book notes which of the two rounds is the one engraved.

Green Jacket

Williams Seals a Second Green Jacket

Only a quadruple bogey at the 14th interrupted a round good enough to share the day's low gross score.

Gregg Williams held his lead in the 2023 Green Jacket race and then made matters worse for everybody else, moving from 14 shots clear to 16. His round at Estoril contained the best golf of his four days and the worst, in that order. The gross 80 was a course personal best, six strokes better than his previous visit to the club.

It was built on two hot patches. Nine Stableford points across holes 2 to 4, then nine more across holes 6 to 8. The second run was completed without dropping a gross shot, on a stretch that includes the 8th, the hardest hole on the course. He arrived at the turn looking like a man who had solved something. A double bogey at the 9th settled that.

The back nine had other ideas. A quadruple bogey 8 at the 14th was the round's low point. He then posted pars at the 15th and 16th, as though nothing whatsoever had happened. The Green Jacket lead never once looked up from its newspaper. Williams was in front throughout.

Wooden Spoon

Alex Baker Sets a New Estoril Worst

Four separate blow-up holes and a fourteen-shot bleed through the turn produced a score Estoril has never seen before.

Alex Baker's fourth round at Estoril Golf Club had no beginning, middle or end. It only had duration. It opened with a quintuple bogey nine at the 1st. Quadruple bogeys followed at the 3rd and the 6th. The nadir came at the 12th, a septuple bogey 11, his worst hole against par of the day. Between the 5th and the 10th he shipped 14 shots across six holes, three of which passed without a single net par.

The gross total was 107. That is a new Estoril record for the worst score ever recorded at the venue, beating the 106 that had stood across six prior visits. It was also eight shots worse than Baker's own effort there last time out. Records fell in both directions at Estoril. Baker took sole responsibility for the direction nobody wants.

The rest was paperwork. A third Wooden Spoon, confirmed. His gap to safety was three shots before the round. It is now four.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 16, Round 4

Rare Feats

— Alex Baker runs up an 11 (+7) at the 12th — his career-worst on a par-4